

Darlington Mponda

Software Developer | Full-Stack Web Applications | AI-Assisted Automation | SaaS Business Systems

Brackenfell, Cape Town, South Africa | [Email](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#)

PROFILE SUMMARY

Software Developer focused on building practical, business-ready web applications, automation systems, and AI-assisted software solutions. Strong Computer Science foundation from Cavendish University Zambia, with hands-on experience developing attendance management systems, appointment booking platforms, admin dashboards, portfolio websites, and SaaS-style business tools. Skilled in Python, Django, JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS, database design, API integration, Git workflows, and cloud deployment. Known for learning quickly, debugging real production issues, and turning business problems into working digital systems.

KEY COMPETENCIES / TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Frameworks: Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Django, ReactJS, FastAPI, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS

Backend & Databases: Django ORM, SQLite, PostgreSQL, REST API concepts, authentication, admin dashboards, data validation

Web & Product Development: Full-stack web apps, booking systems, attendance systems, CRUD apps, responsive UI, SaaS product structure

AI & Automation: ChatGPT, Codex, AI-assisted coding workflows, prompt engineering, workflow automation, debugging support

Deployment & Tools: Git, GitHub, Vercel, Render, VS Code, PowerShell, Git Bash, Python virtual environments, environment variables

Business Software: Client-focused systems, feature planning, pricing structure, technical documentation, user flows, product thinking

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer / Independent Full-Stack Developer

Project-Based Work | Brackenfell, Cape Town

- Builds practical web applications and business systems for real-world use cases including attendance tracking, booking management, school administration, and portfolio presentation.
- Uses Python, Django, JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS, Git, GitHub, Vercel, and Render to create, version, debug, and deploy applications.
- Applies AI-assisted development workflows using Codex and ChatGPT to speed up coding, troubleshoot stack traces, improve UI structure, and strengthen backend logic.
- Frames projects with SaaS readiness in mind, including reusable features, admin controls, database structure, pricing tiers, and deployment planning.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Employee Attendance Management System

Technologies: Python, Django, SQLite, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Django Admin

- Developed a web-based attendance management system with employee records, attendance tracking, clock-in and clock-out functionality, and admin controls.
- Created database models for employee information, departments, positions, salaries, status, and attendance logs.
- Configured Django Admin search, filters, and action tools to help managers view and update employee and attendance records efficiently.
- Structured the system as a small-business product that can expand into payroll support, reporting, and SaaS subscription features.

Booking Appointment Web Application

Technologies: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, GitHub, Vercel

- Designed and developed a service-based booking website with responsive sections for services, customer enquiries, and appointment requests.
- Used Git and GitHub for version control and managed production deployment updates through Vercel.
- Built the project as a reusable template for consultants, clinics, salons, repair businesses, and other appointment-based service providers.

School Finance / Admin Management System

Technologies: Python, Django, SQLite/PostgreSQL concepts, HTML, CSS

- Built the foundation for a school administration and finance management application with backend models, views, routes, and admin features.
- Worked through real Django debugging challenges involving settings configuration, WSGI imports, virtual environments, and local server errors.
- Designed the structure for future modules including student records, payment tracking, dashboards, and administrative reporting.

Developer Portfolio Website

Technologies: React, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Render

- Created a personal portfolio page to present technical skills, selected projects, professional profile, and contact links.
- Deployed the portfolio on Render and connected it to a professional CV and GitHub profile for recruiter/client access.

EDUCATION

Computer Science - Cavendish University Zambia

Studied programming fundamentals, databases, software development, system design, and problem-solving, now applied through full-stack web applications, automation systems, and business software projects.

PROFESSIONAL ATTRIBUTES

- Fast learner with strong practical execution and problem-solving ability.
- Comfortable taking a project from idea to working application through research, coding, testing, debugging, and deployment.
- Business-minded approach to software development with interest in SaaS, automation, and AI-powered products.
- Proactive, adaptable, and able to learn new tools quickly when solving real client or product problems.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built multiple working software applications within a short learning period using disciplined AI-assisted development workflows.
- Developed both executable-style and web-based business systems for attendance and operations management.
- Deployed live web projects using GitHub, Vercel, and Render while troubleshooting production update issues.
- Converted raw project ideas into structured SaaS-ready software concepts with clear features and business use cases.